

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Source-led chronology

GUPTA ERA 319-20 CE -> conventional imperial phase

PRAYAG PRASHASTI -> campaign categories + royal ideology

COINS -> titles, images, ritual and monetary zones

COPPER PLATES / SEALS -> offices, grants and local actors

FAXIAN -> selected Buddhist and social observations

RULE: triangulate sources; prashasti praise and coin circulation are not border maps.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Formation and Chandragupta I

SRI GUPTA -> GHATOTKACHA -> CHANDRAGUPTA I

maharaja                      maharajadhiraja

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Kumaradevi-Lichchhavi alliance represented on coin type

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Ganga core + alliance + inherited routes + symbolic legitimacy

LIMIT: the coin proves advertised alliance, not a measurable dowry or exact border.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Samudragupta's graded sovereignty

ARYAVARTA -> rulers uprooted -> stronger core incorporation

ATAVIKA -> subordinated forest rulers

FRONTIER STATES / GANAS -> tribute, orders and obeisance

DAKSHINAPATHA -> captured, released and reinstated

DISTANT RULERS / ISLANDS -> gifts, service and prestige diplomacy

VERDICT: annexation, subordination and hegemony coexisted; not every name was a province.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Chandragupta II and western expansion

SUCCESSION AND ALLIANCE CAPACITY

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defeat of western Kshatrapas in Malwa-Gujarat

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access to western routes, silver-coin zone and prestige centres

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Udayagiri and royal imagery strengthen Vaishnava political communication

CAUTION: Vikramaditya/Navaratna traditions require source and chronology control.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Late Guptas, Hunas and decline

KUMARAGUPTA -> SKANDAGUPTA -> LATER GUPTAS

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succession strains + Huna pressure + feudatory autonomy

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fiscal and military burdens + regional powers + changing networks

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contracting imperial authority

VERDICT: decline was cumulative and regional, not one invasion or instant collapse.

## ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Territoriality and administration

KING / COURT

- > bhukti provincial level
- > vishaya district level
- > town / village bodies and local notables
- > feudatories and frontier rulers

OFFICES and practice varied by region; Bengal plates are especially visible.

EMPIRE = directly ruled core + delegated administration + layered hegemony.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Land grants and fiscal decentralisation

### ROYAL CHARTER

- > land / revenue rights + exemptions + boundary record
- > Brahmana or religious beneficiary
- > local cultivators, labour and intermediaries
- > agrarian expansion + legitimation + fiscal reallocation

DEBATE: grants could strengthen frontier integration while also enlarging local autonomy.

RULE: read the exact rights; do not assume every grant transferred total sovereignty.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Economy, coinage and urban change

GOLD COINS -> royal high-value capacity and imagery

SILVER ISSUES -> western zone after Kshatrapa conquest

COPPER SCARCITY / REGIONAL MEDIA -> uneven everyday monetisation

GUILDS / CRAFTS / PORTS -> continuity in selected nodes

URBAN EVIDENCE -> contraction in some centres, persistence or relocation in others

VERDICT: neither universal prosperity nor total urban collapse fits the evidence.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Society, Faxian and religion

VARNA / JATI / OCCUPATION -> norm and lived diversity

VISHTI -> labour obligation in selected grants

FAXIAN -> Buddhist pilgrim lens; Chandala passage and institutional observations

VAISHNAVA / SHAIVA / SHAKTA patronage + Buddhist and Jain continuities

ROYAL AND NON-ROYAL DONORS -> plural religious landscape

LIMIT: normative texts and traveller accounts are not censuses.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Literature, science and arts

SANSKRIT COURT CULTURE -> Kalidasa / Amarasimha traditions

MATHEMATICS-ASTRONOMY -> Aryabhatiya, 499 CE

METALLURGY -> Mehrauli iron pillar with attribution caution

ARCHITECTURE -> Udayagiri, Sanchi 17, Bhitargaon and Deogarh

SCULPTURE / PAINTING -> Mathura, Sarnath and Vakataka-context Ajanta

RULE: name work, date, patronage context and ownership limit.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Golden Age and historiography

FOR: durable literature + science + sculpture + temple forms + political prestige

AGAINST UNIVERSAL LABEL:

- |-- regional production beyond direct Gupta rule
- |-- hierarchy, exclusion, vishti and patriarchal norms
- |-- uneven urban and monetary conditions
- `-- elite-source bias

VERDICT: a bounded classical florescence, not a census judgement on all society.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Gupta answer spine

OPEN: inscription- and coin-led layered empire, c. 319-550 CE

RULERS: formation -> Samudragupta -> Chandragupta II -> late pressures

POLITY: graded sovereignty + administration + feudatories

ECONOMY: grants + agrarian base + coins + urban variation

CULTURE: use only bounded examples; Topic 21 owns social-cultural depth

QUALIFY: genre, region, attribution and distribution

VERDICT: high-capacity core with negotiated and changing peripheries.